

01 · THE SERIES

EMOTIONAL ROLLER COASTER

WHY SHE WON'T TALK
AFTER THE GAME



IT'S NOT ABOUT THE MATCH. IT'S EVERYTHING THAT LED TO IT.



THE SERIES

FIVE LESSONS. ONE PLAYER.

01

Why She Won't Talk After the Game

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02

Your Nervous System Is on the Court

Coming up.

03

Reading Your Own Behavior Patterns

Coming up.

04

From Roller Coaster to Anchor

Coming up.

05

The Regulation Practice

Coming up.

HEAR THIS ONCE

IF SHE'S NOT COMING
TO YOU AFTER THE GAME,
SHE'S NOT BEING DIFFICULT.
SHE'S AVOIDING
YOUR ENERGY.

This is not about placing blame. It's about identifying where the work is so we can change the outcome.

— SHE READS YOUR ENERGY BEFORE SHE READS THE SCORE

WHAT'S ACTUALLY HAPPENING

IT'S NOT THE
MOMENT AFTER
THE MATCH.
IT'S EVERYTHING
BEFORE IT.

→ Your energy during warmup: she's already reading you

→ Your visible reactions during play: she's tracking every one

→ Your emotional state after the final whistle: this is what determines if she comes to you

— THE POST-GAME CONVERSATION STARTS BEFORE THE GAME.

05 · WHAT SHE'S TRACKING

THE SIGNALS SHE READS

YOUR BODY LANGUAGE

Pacing, arms crossed, visible frustration she sees all of it and carries it onto the court.

YOUR AUDIBLE REACTIONS

Every sound after a point or error is data she's processing mid-competition.

YOUR POST-GAME ENERGY

The emotional state you arrive with after the final whistle sets the entire conversation.



06 · WHAT SHE NEEDS INSTEAD

THE ANCHOR SHE'S LOOKING FOR

CONSISTENCY

Same energy after a win as after a loss. Not flat steady.

SAFETY

She needs to know that coming to you after a hard match doesn't mean walking into a storm.

NO AGENDA

A parent with no emotional stake in the outcome creates the safest landing space.

02

07 · REMEMBER THIS

SAVE THIS COME BACK TO IT

SHE ISN'T AVOIDING
THE CONVERSATION.
SHE'S AVOIDING
THE ENERGY SHE KNOWS
IS WAITING FOR HER.

SAVE THIS. COME BACK TO IT.

— YOUR ENERGY IS ON THE COURT

THIS WEEK

AUDIT YOUR GAME-DAY ENERGY PATTERN.

✓ Before the next match, write down how you want to show up not how you want her to play.

✓ During the match, track your visible reactions: how many? What triggered them?

✓ After the match, wait. Let her come to you. Notice how long it takes.

✓ Ask yourself honestly: would you want to come to you after a hard match?



EMOTIONAL ANCHOR

YOUR NERVOUS SYSTEM
IS ON THE COURT

02

CO-REGULATION IS REAL. AND IT WORKS IN BOTH DIRECTIONS.



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HEAR THIS ONCE

YOUR NERVOUS SYSTEM
DOESN'T STAY
IN THE STANDS.
SHE FEELS IT
ON THE COURT.

This isn't metaphorical. The research on co-regulation is clear: caregivers' nervous states directly affect the stress response of the people around them.

— YOU REGULATE HER BY REGULATING YOURSELF FIRST

CO - REGULATION

HER NERVOUS SYSTEM TAKES CUES FROM YOURS.

→ When you're dysregulated: her cortisol spikes, focus narrows, performance drops

→ When you're regulated: she has access to the calm she needs to compete

→ The transfer happens unconsciously she doesn't have to see you for it to work

— YOUR REGULATION IS A PERFORMANCE VARIABLE.

05 · WHAT DYSREGULATION LOOKS LIKE

IN YOU, IN HER

IN YOU

Tension before the match, visible frustration during, emotional aftermath after.

IN HER

Tight shoulders, rushed decisions, plays not to lose instead of playing to compete.

THE LOOP

Your anxiety becomes her anxiety becomes worse performance becomes more anxiety.



06 · BECOMING THE ANCHOR

WHAT REGULATION FEELS LIKE TO BUILD

BEFORE THE MATCH

Breathing exercise in the car. Name your emotional state. Set your intention.

DURING THE MATCH

Find one thing to appreciate regardless of the score. It redirects the nervous system.

AFTER THE MATCH

Regulate before approaching. If you're not steady, wait until you are.



07 · REMEMBER THIS

SAVE THIS COME BACK TO IT

YOU CAN'T GIVE HER
CALM YOU DON'T HAVE.
REGULATE YOURSELF FIRST.
THEN REACH FOR HER

SAVE THIS. COME BACK TO IT.

— REGULATE FIRST, CONNECT SECOND

THIS WEEK

PRACTICE PRE-MATCH REGULATION THIS WEEK.

- ✓ In the car on the way to the next competition, take 3 slow breaths and name how you're feeling.
- ✓ Set one intention: 'today my job is to stay steady regardless of the score.'
- ✓ During the match, find two things to genuinely appreciate the effort, a moment of growth, anything.
- ✓ After the match, wait 5 minutes before approaching. Use those 5 minutes to regulate first.



EMOTIONAL ANCHOR

READING YOUR OWN
BEHAVIOR PATTERNS

03

YOU CAN'T CHANGE WHAT YOU HAVEN'T NAMED.



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HEAR THIS ONCE

ASK YOURSELF:
DO YOU GET VISIBLY
UPSET AFTER A LOSS?
SUPER HYPED AFTER
A WIN?
SHE'S FEELING
BOTH OF THOSE.

The roller coaster isn't just your emotional experience. She's riding every peak and valley with you.

— NAME IT BEFORE YOU CAN CHANGE IT

THE BEHAVIOR AUDIT

WHICH OF THESE IS YOU?

- After a mistake: visible reaction, audible comment, physical movement
- After a loss: prolonged silence, visible upset, emotional distance
- After a win: super hyped, high expectations for next one, the bar moves up

— THE PATTERN YOU CAN'T SEE IS THE ONE THAT COSTS THE MOST.

05 · THE FOUR SIDELINE PATTERNS

WHICH ONE ARE YOU?

THE COMMENTATOR

Audible after every play points and errors.

THE PACER

Physical movement tracks every moment of competition.

THE DISAPPEARER

Visible emotional withdrawal after bad moments.



06 · GETTING HONEST

HOW TO SEE YOURSELF CLEARLY

ASK HER

'What do you notice from me during a match?' is the most valuable question you'll ever ask.

VIDEO

If anyone has recorded competitions, watch yourself not her.

THE MIRROR TEST

Ask yourself honestly: if I were an athlete, would I want my parent behaving like this?



07 · REMEMBER THIS

SAVE THIS · COME BACK TO IT

THE FIRST STEP
TO BECOMING THE ANCHOR
HER PERFORMANCE NEEDS
IS SEEING HONESTLY
WHERE THE ROLLER
COASTER LIVES IN YOU.

SAVE THIS. COME BACK TO IT.

— SEE YOURSELF CLEARLY

THIS WEEK

RUN YOUR BEHAVIOR AUDIT THIS WEEK.

- ✓ Ask your athlete: what do you notice from me before, during, and after matches?
- ✓ Listen without defending. Write down what she says.
- ✓ Watch video of yourself at a competition if any exists.
- ✓ Pick one specific behavior pattern to change before the next event.



EMOTIONAL ANCHOR

FROM ROLLER COASTER
TO ANCHOR



THE SHIFT ISN'T ABOUT SUPPRESSING EMOTION. IT'S ABOUT CHOOSING RESPONSE.



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HEAR THIS ONCE

BEING AN ANCHOR
DOESN'T MEAN
BEING FLAT.
IT MEANS BEING
STEADY.

An anchor is not an emotionless person. It's a person whose emotional response doesn't destabilize the people around them.

— STEADY IS NOT EMOTIONLESS

WHAT AN ANCHOR IS

SAME FACE. DIFFERENT SCORE.

- Consistent energy across wins and losses not identical, but stable
- Genuine positive presence without the spikes that come with high emotional investment in the score
- The ability to regulate before responding choosing response over reaction

— SHE NEEDS TO BELIEVE YOU'LL BE OKAY NO MATTER WHAT HAPPENS OUT THERE.

05 · BUILDING THE ANCHOR

WHAT THE SHIFT LOOKS LIKE

BEFORE

Set an emotional intention before every competition. Name it in writing.

DURING

Identify your trigger in advance. Plan your response to it before it arrives.

AFTER

Wait until you're regulated. Then lead with one observation that has nothing to do with the score.



06 · THE PAYOFF

WHAT CHANGES WHEN YOU DO

SHE COMES TO YOU

Athletes come to parents who feel safe. They avoid ones who don't.

SHE PERFORMS BETTER

Athletes who don't have to manage their parent's emotions have more bandwidth for the game.

THE RELATIONSHIP DEEPENS

When sport stops being a source of stress between you, it becomes a source of connection.

02

07 · REMEMBER THIS

SAVE THIS COME BACK TO IT

YOU DON'T HAVE TO
NOT CARE.
YOU HAVE TO CARE
IN A WAY THAT
DOESN'T COST HER

SAVE THIS. COME BACK TO IT.

— STEADY IS THE GOAL

THIS WEEK

BUILD YOUR ANCHOR PRACTICE THIS WEEK.

✓ Before the next competition, write your emotional intention: 'I will be steady regardless of the score.'

✓ Identify your personal trigger in advance the moment that most destabilizes you.

✓ Plan your response to that trigger before it arrives.

✓ After the match, lead with one observation about effort or growth not the score.



EMOTIONAL ANCHOR

THE REGULATION PRACTICE

OS

EMOTIONAL REGULATION IS A SKILL. IT REQUIRES TRAINING.



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HEAR THIS ONCE

EMOTIONAL REGULATION
IS NOT A PERSONALITY
TRAIT.
IT'S A SKILL YOU
BUILD WITH PRACTICE.

You wouldn't expect your athlete to master a serve without drilling it. The same applies to your regulation.

— TRAIN IT OR IT WON'T SHOW UP WHEN IT COUNTS

THE REGULATION PRACTICE

Before, during, after every competition.

→ Before: breathe, name your emotional state, set intention in writing

→ During: identify and neutralize one trigger before it arrives

→ After: regulate first, connect second always in that order

— THE REGULATED PARENT IS THE ONE SHE RUNS TOWARD.

WHAT TO USE

BOX BREATHING

4 counts in, 4 hold, 4 out, 4 hold. Use it in the car before the match.

THE APPRECIATION RESET

Find something genuine to appreciate mid-competition. It interrupts the cortisol spiral.

THE NAME GAME

Name your emotion before you express it. 'I'm feeling anxious right now' interrupts the automatic response.



06 · TRACKING PROGRESS

HOW TO KNOW IT'S WORKING

SHE COMES TO YOU MORE

The post-game car ride gets easier. That's the metric.

SHE PERFORMS MORE CONSISTENTLY

Her match performance starts matching her practice performance.

YOU FEEL DIFFERENT

Competitions feel less like survival and more like something you actually look forward to.

02

07 · REMEMBER THIS

SAVE THIS COME BACK TO IT

THE MOST POWERFUL
THING YOU CAN GIVE HER
BEFORE A BIG MATCH
IS A PARENT
WHO IS ALREADY OKAY.

SAVE THIS. COME BACK TO IT.

— REGULATED PARENTS RAISE REGULATED ATHLETES

THIS WEEK

START YOUR REGULATION PRACTICE TODAY.

- ✓ Before the next competition: box breathing in the car, write your intention on your phone.
- ✓ During: identify your trigger in advance and have your replacement response ready.
- ✓ After: wait 5 minutes before approaching. Regulate first.
- ✓ At season end: look back at the post-game relationship. Has it changed? What drove the change?